

RUI ZHENG

Centre for AI and Decision Sciences
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EDUCATION

University of Manchester PhD Business and Management (PhD research progress was hindered by the Pandemic) Supervisors: Professor Yu-wang Chen, Dr. Luis Ospina-Forero	9/2020 – 9/2025
University of Manchester MSc Statistics	9/2019 – 9/2020
University of Manchester BSc Mathematics with Financial Mathematics	9/2016 – 6/2019

RESEARCH INTEREST

- AI & Machine Learning
- Data Analytics
- Social Network Analysis
- Information Diffusion
- Decision Science
- Belief & Decision Dynamics

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, University of Manchester

- BMAN24621 Business Data Analytics 2021 – 2025
Course leader: Prof. Yu-wang Chen
Assisted interactive workshops using SAS, Tableau, and Trifacta, promoting hands-on learning and guiding students through complex analytical problems.
- BMAN31260 ITMB Final Year Project 2024
Course leader: Dr. Tahir abbas Syed
Supported final-year undergraduate students in developing and presenting, and offering feedback.
- BMAN11060 Fundamentals of Data Analytics 2021 – 2022
Course leader: Dr. Rotimi Ogunakin
Facilitated practical lab sessions, introducing undergraduate students to foundational concepts and tools in data analytics.

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Papers

Rui Zheng, Luis Ospina-Forero, and Yu-wang Chen, 2024. Implications of social network structures on socially influenced decision-making. *Decision*, 51(1), pp.85-103. [[Link](#)]

Tao Wen, **Rui Zheng**, Ting Wu, Zeyi Liu, Mi Zhou, Tahir Abbas Syed, Darminder Ghataoura, Yu-wang Chen, 2025. Formulating opinion dynamics from belief formation, diffusion and updating in social network group decision-making: Towards developing a holistic framework. *European Journal of Operational Research*, 325(3), pp.381-399. [[Link](#)]

Working Papers and Papers in the pipeline

Rui Zheng, Luis Ospina-Forero, and Yu-wang Chen, Similarity-Based Network Analysis of Social Attitudes and Decision-Making: Analytical Evidence from RAND American Life Panel Data. Under Preparation for *Decision Sciences*.

Rui Zheng, Luis Ospina-Forero, and Yu-wang Chen, Understanding the Structure and Dynamics of the Global Vaccine Product Trade Network. Under Preparation for *Social Science and Medicine*.

David Carranza, Devansh Sharma, Francisco Malveiro, Gustavo Kohlrausch, Jisha Mariyam John, Kaloyan Danovski, Malvina Bozhidarova, **Rui Zheng**, Sandro Sousa. Walking Through Complex Spatial Patterns of Climate and Conflict-Induced Displacements. arXiv:2506.22120 [[Link](#)]

SCHOLARSHIP, HONORS AND AWARDS

Decision and Cognitive Sciences Research Centre , Support Fund (£1,000)	2022
Outstanding student award in School of Mathematics (£2,000)	2019
The Stellify Award , University of Manchester	2019
Outstanding Winner , The “Chunhui Cup” Innovation and Entrepreneurship Competition for Overseas Chinese Scholars	2018

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Strength2Farm – Horizon Europe Programme	7/2026-present
University of Manchester. PI: Dr. Arijit De	
• Developed agent-based simulation and machine-learning models for agri-food supply chain analysis. • Designed scenario-based, multimodal logistics simulations to evaluate cost, emissions, resilience, and service performance. • Applied network analysis and data-driven modelling to support supply-chain planning and decision-making.	
AI-Augmented Intelligent Road-Rail Logistics for Multimodal Supply Chain in UK	10/2025–7/2026
University of Manchester. PI: Dr. Arijit De	
• Developed AI-driven logistics models and simulation engines for analysing cost–emissions–service trade-offs under uncertainty. • Designed scenario-based optimisation and routing simulations across multi-modal, urban–rural supply chains. • Built interpretable decision-support tools to inform operational and infrastructure planning for SMEs and policymakers.	
Interpretable data-driven modelling to quantifying the effect of social influence in decision making	9/2020 – 6/2025
University of Manchester. Advisors: Professor Yu-wang Chen and Dr. Luis Ospina-Forero	
• Analysed how decision-making is influenced by social influences through a mixture modelling method of big data analytics, statistics and network analysis. • Captured the interrelationship of personal characteristics and social influential factors to integrate the belief model.	

AI modelling and data analytics for COVID-19 pandemic response and recovery 3/2021 – 6/2021

University of Manchester. Advisors: Professor Yu-wang Chen and Professor Dong-ling Xu

- Conducted an extensive literature review on AI and data-driven approaches to pandemic modelling and public health response.
- Collected and pre-processed COVID-19 related datasets to support model development and scenario analysis.

PRESENTATIONS

Understanding the structure and dynamics of the global vaccine product trade network

- 33rd European Conference on Operation Research, Copenhagen, Denmark. 7/2024
- PhD Presentation and Networking, The Alan Turing Institute, London, UK 3/2024

Implications of social network structures on socially influenced decision making.

- Postgraduate Summer Research Showcase, Manchester, UK 6/2023
- Advances in Data Science and AI Conference, Manchester, UK. 6/2023
- British Academy of Management 2022 Conference, Manchester, UK. 9/2022
- AMBS Doctoral Research Conference, Manchester, UK. 7/2020

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

Complexity 72h Workshop 6/2025

Madrid, Spain

EURO PhD Summer School on MCDA/MCDM 7/2022

Ankara, Turkey.

SOCIAL ACTIVITIES

Manchester China Innovation and Entrepreneurship Base 2020 – 2024

Director, Manchester

- Led collaborative initiatives bridging academic research with entrepreneurial practice among Chinese scholars in the UK.
- Facilitated knowledge transfer between universities and startups, supporting innovation and cross-cultural engagement.

Chinese Students and Scholars Association in Manchester 2018 – present

Vice-president, Manchester

- Organised large-scale cultural and academic events to support the Chinese student community.
- Strengthened student engagement and leadership development through mentoring and outreach activities.

SKILLS

Programming: Python, MATLAB, R language, LaTeX, Gephi, UCINET, SAS, Trifacta, Tableau.

Languages: Mandarin, English, Italian.

REFERENCES

Prof. Dr. Yu-Wang Chen

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